

Greenfield University

Academic Integrity Policy 2025–2026

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1. Preamble

Academic integrity is the foundation of all scholarly work at Greenfield University. Intellectual honesty, originality, and ethical conduct in all academic pursuits are expected of every member of the university community — students, faculty, and researchers alike.

This policy defines academic dishonesty, outlines the procedures for reporting and investigation, and specifies sanctions for violations. GU is committed to fostering a culture where the value of honest academic work is recognized and rewarded.

2. Definitions

2.1 Plagiarism

Plagiarism is the use of another person's ideas, words, data, or work — whether published or unpublished — without proper acknowledgment or attribution.

Examples of plagiarism include:

- Copying sentences or paragraphs verbatim from any source without quotation marks and citation
- Paraphrasing another's work without attribution
- Submitting another student's work as one's own
- Copying code from online sources (GitHub, Stack Overflow, etc.) without attribution
- Self-plagiarism: submitting previously submitted work in another course without faculty approval
- Purchasing or downloading essays/assignments from academic paper mills

2.2 Cheating

Cheating involves any act of deception in academic work:

- Copying from another student during examinations

- Using unauthorized materials (notes, devices) during tests
- Sharing examination questions before an exam
- Impersonating another student or having someone take one's exam

2.3 Fabrication

Fabrication is the unauthorized invention or falsification of data, citations, or results:

- Inventing research data or lab results
- Falsifying experimental results
- Citing sources that do not exist or do not contain the cited content

2.4 Collusion

Unauthorized collaboration on individual assignments:

- Working jointly with another student on an individual assignment without faculty permission
- Sharing answers or work on take-home exams that are to be individual submissions

2.5 Misrepresentation

- Providing false information in academic records, CVs, or applications
- Submitting forged or altered academic documents
- Misrepresenting reasons for extensions, absences, or grade appeals

2.6 Facilitation

Helping another student commit academic dishonesty:

- Sharing answers or completed work
 - Allowing others to copy from your work
 - Doing another student's assignment for them
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3. Plagiarism Detection

All written submissions at GU are subject to **plagiarism screening** using:

- **Turnitin** (integrated with the LMS)
- **iThenticate** (for research papers and dissertations)
- **GU Custom Code Similarity Checker** (for programming assignments)

3.1 Similarity Thresholds

Similarity Index	Status
0% - 15%	Acceptable
16% - 25%	Minor concern — review required by faculty
26% - 40%	Moderate plagiarism — penalty applied
> 40%	Severe plagiarism — disciplinary proceedings

These thresholds may be adjusted based on the nature of the assignment (literature reviews may have higher acceptable limits).

3.2 Original Work Declaration

Every student must submit a **Declaration of Originality** with all major assignments:

"I hereby certify that the work submitted is entirely my own (or, where group work, of our group). I have acknowledged all sources used and have not submitted this work for any other course or institution."

4. Proper Citation & Attribution

Students at GU are expected to follow the **citation style prescribed by their school**:

School	Citation Style
School of Engineering & Technology	IEEE
School of Management	APA 7th Edition
School of Sciences	ACS / APA
School of Humanities	MLA 9th Edition
School of Law	Bluebook (Indian Adaptation)
School of Commerce	APA 7th Edition

Citation workshops are conducted by the **GU Library** at the start of each academic year. Attendance is strongly recommended.

5. Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) Tools

5.1 Policy on Generative AI

The use of generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Gemini, etc.) in academic work is governed by the following framework:

Use Case	Policy
Idea generation / brainstorming	Permitted (must disclose)
Grammar checking / proofreading	Permitted (must disclose)
Generating full assignment text	Prohibited
Generating code for submission	Prohibited (unless explicitly allowed)
Literature summaries submitted as own	Prohibited
AI assistance in research (with disclosure)	Permitted in select cases — faculty approval required

5.2 Disclosure Requirement

If AI tools are used in any permitted capacity, students must include an **AI Disclosure Statement** at the end of their submission specifying:

- Tool used
 - Nature of use
 - How the output was modified/verified
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6. Reporting Procedure

6.1 By Faculty

A faculty member who suspects academic dishonesty must:

1. Collect and preserve evidence (similarity report, original and submitted documents, exam paper)
2. Inform the student of the concern in writing within 5 working days
3. Complete a **Violation Report Form** and submit to the HOD
4. The HOD escalates to the **Academic Integrity Committee (AIC)**

Faculty must not impose penalties unilaterally (beyond a warning for first minor offences) before the AIC process.

6.2 By Students

Students who witness academic dishonesty may report:

- To the concerned faculty member
 - To the HOD
 - Via the **GU Ethics Portal** (ethics.greenfield.edu.in) — anonymous reporting permitted
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7. Academic Integrity Committee (AIC)

7.1 Composition

Member	Role
Dean of Academic Affairs	Chairperson
Dean of the concerned School	Member
Head of Department (concerned)	Member
Two Senior Faculty Members	Members
One Student Representative	Member
Registrar (or nominee)	Member-Secretary

7.2 Jurisdiction

The AIC handles all cases of academic dishonesty referred by faculty, HODs, or deans. It has the authority to:

- Summon students and witnesses
 - Review evidence
 - Impose sanctions (within the limits defined in Section 8)
 - Recommend expulsion (to be approved by the Vice-Chancellor)
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8. Sanctions

8.1 For Students

Severity	Examples	Sanctions
Minor	Minor paraphrasing without citation; using AI for minor edits	Warning + mandatory citation workshop; resubmission required
Moderate	Significant plagiarism (26-40%); unauthorized collaboration	Zero on the assignment; grade capped at 'C' for the course
Major	>40% plagiarism; cheating in exams; fabrication	Zero in the course (F grade); suspension for 1 semester
Severe	Impersonation; degree fraud; fabrication in thesis	Expulsion; degree revocation (if already awarded); possible FIR

8.2 Repeat Offences

- A second offence at any level is treated as one level higher (Minor → Moderate; Moderate → Major)
- A third offence results in automatic expulsion proceedings

8.3 For Faculty

Faculty who facilitate, condone, or ignore academic dishonesty may face:

- Formal reprimand
- Removal from supervisory/examination roles
- Disciplinary proceedings under the GU Service Rules

9. Appeals

A student penalized by the AIC may appeal:

- Within **15 working days** of receiving the sanction
- To the **Vice-Chancellor** (or a designated appellate body)
- Appeal must state grounds clearly and attach supporting evidence
- The appellate authority's decision is final

10. Education & Prevention

10.1 Academic Integrity Week

Conducted every September, featuring:

- Workshops on citation, plagiarism prevention, and research ethics
- Guest lectures from academic integrity professionals
- Interactive case study sessions

10.2 Orientation

All new students undergo a mandatory **2-hour Academic Integrity Orientation** in the first week of the odd semester.

10.3 Online Module

A self-paced **Academic Integrity Online Module** is available on the LMS:

- Duration: 90 minutes
- Compulsory for all first-year students
- Certificate of completion issued

10.4 Resources

Resource	Location
Plagiarism Checker	lms.greenfield.edu.in
Citation Generator	library.greenfield.edu.in/cite
Academic Integrity Handbook	ethics.greenfield.edu.in/handbook
AI Policy FAQ	ethics.greenfield.edu.in/ai-policy

11. Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually by the Academic Council. Students and faculty may suggest amendments via:

- Email: academicintegrity@greenfield.edu.in
 - Ethics Portal feedback form
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12. Contact

Office	Contact
Academic Integrity Committee	aic@greenfield.edu.in
Dean of Academic Affairs	academics@greenfield.edu.in
Ethics Reporting Portal	ethics.greenfield.edu.in
GU Library (Citation Help)	library@greenfield.edu.in

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